NO LONGER THE FIRST

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To this day I can remember my very first girlfriend. Probably because she was the only girlfriend I've ever had. People have asked me how… over the course of 20 years have I only had one girlfriend? And to be honest, I don't know. I'm shy, I guess. Talking to girls isn't something that comes naturally to me. I either say something really stupid, or I can't even work up enough nerve to say anything at all. And yeah, it's embarrassing- to say that the only girlfriend I've ever had was back in the 7th grade.

So I'm sitting in my Anatomy for Bio Majors class, when this girl walks in. And you can tell from the moment you saw her that she was just one of those girls who you knew you couldn't have. The girl with that perfect smile and personality. Well, after about 20 seconds of praying to God that she sat next to me, take a guess where she ended up. So here I am trying to think of something to say to her when she beats me to the punch and says "Hi I'm Alison." So trying to play it cool, I say (Cracked voice) "Hey… Hey, I'm Ben." And as I can feel the blood rushing out of my face she laughs… and says "Nice to meet you."

Over the next couple of weeks, we started to get pretty friendly. She'd come to class and sit down next to me and we would talk for a while until class started. I'd generally try to say something funny, which usually came out wrong… and like always, she would just laugh. You know one day I made some sort of joke that her and I should go out and the next thing I know she's actually giving me her number. So after practicing what I was gonna say around 65 times, I finally worked up enough nerve to ask her out. And she said yes.

The first few dates were awesome. After we went out we would go back to my apartment and talk until we fell asleep or well, usually until I fell asleep. Anyways, one night, we got back to my place after going to see some little chick flick and Alison said

she wanted to thank me for putting up with her crying throughout the movie… Remember that Anatomy class? Well, let's just say I got a head start on that homework!

It was hard to believe that three months had already passed since we started dating. It's been a great three months, but over the past few days Alison had seemed kind of distant. As we walked to class that Monday, she stopped me. She said "Ben, I need to talk to you. (Pause) I'm pregnant Ben."

"What? You're telling me that after all- Well, I hope you and whoever the hell the father is are, really happy!" And she laughed and said "Me too. I'm sorry to spring this on you, but I need to know that you're here for us Ben… if not" "No! I am. I love you Alison. And I'm gonna love that baby too."

How is this possible? How am I supposed to take care of a baby? Shit, I'm still a baby. I used to laugh at the people who were in my situation. Used to wonder how someone could be so stupid. Well I'm not laughing anymore.

So I found out today that it's a girl (Laugh then stop)- Kind of disappointed. Girls are great if you love little pink bows and barbies- I hate that shit. Alison's at that point now where she is sick, like, every morning. It's funny cuz, after she threw up the other day she asked me if I still thought she was beautiful. And I said "Yes, you are still beautiful… right in here." (Pointing to my heart). That wasn't the answer she wanted to hear. And then she proceeded to throw up on my feet… Again.

We went in the other day for a little check up and the doctor told us that everything is going great, but right now, Alison's a wreck. Over the past week or so I've stayed up with her almost all night just playing with her hair until she fell asleep on me. Look, I know she's pregnant and sick and everything… but it's getting really tough for me too. It's just getting really tough…

So, I wake up the other night only to find that my leg is covered in water breakage. So I start to freak out and hurry to clean myself off, and then we rush off to the hospital. At this point I'm starting to get really nervous… because I'm about to be a father. But at the same time I'm really excited… because I'm about to be a father. But, pretty nervous (Pee running down leg)… oh boy, yeah that's water breakage running down my leg right now.

After what seemed like forever, Alison finally went in to labor… and for that matter, I felt like I did too. She kept yelling at me and telling me that this whole thing was my fault. She started to scream "You bastard, you bastard, you did this to me," then the nurse epiduraled her ass!

When the doctor finally came in he started to mess around… down there and he asked me if I wanted to see what was going on. So I- "Oh my God, that is disgusting!" And then she started to scream again. So the doctor asked me to leave.

I'm having a hard time sitting still. Every few seconds I keep looking up, waiting for the good news… When the doctor finally came out, I ran up to him and say "Hey! How's my baby? How's my baby girl?" (Pause) He just stood there for a minute. "Ben, during the child birth, there were some complications. Things that you just can't foresee. I'm sorry Ben. Your baby-"

Is gone! Right? Yeah look, I need to go see Alison." "Ben, your baby is fine. But during child birth, Alison"

"No… you shut-up! Just shut up and stop lying to me. Just shut up and tell me you're lying." (Long pause)

It's called Eclampsia. I don't really know what it is… I didn't even ask. I just know that she had it. (Sad smile) We didn't even get the chance to talk about names. Doctors told me I get to see her tomorrow, my little girl. I'm looking forward to that.

As I walked to the nursery the next day, I thought about all the things I wanted to tell my little girl. Things I wanted to tell her about myself, and her mother. But when I saw her- (Short of breath). She's beautiful. She's has her mother's eyes, and her nose and her chin. She looks just like her. She's got my ears… which, is kind of unfortunate (slight laugh). But she's beautiful.

(Whispering) "Hey little girl… I'm your dad. Your mom, she's not here now, but, she loves you. And so do I. So right now, It's just gonna be you and me now little girl." (Pause and smile)